

Ralph Lauren Clienteling App

WhatsApp Restriction Investigation Report

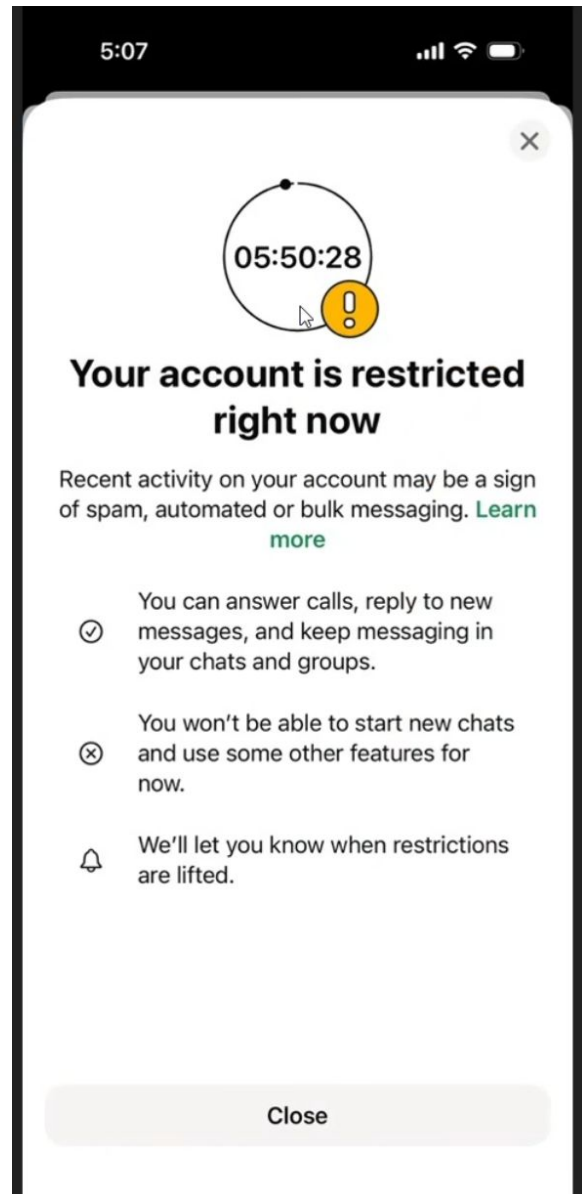
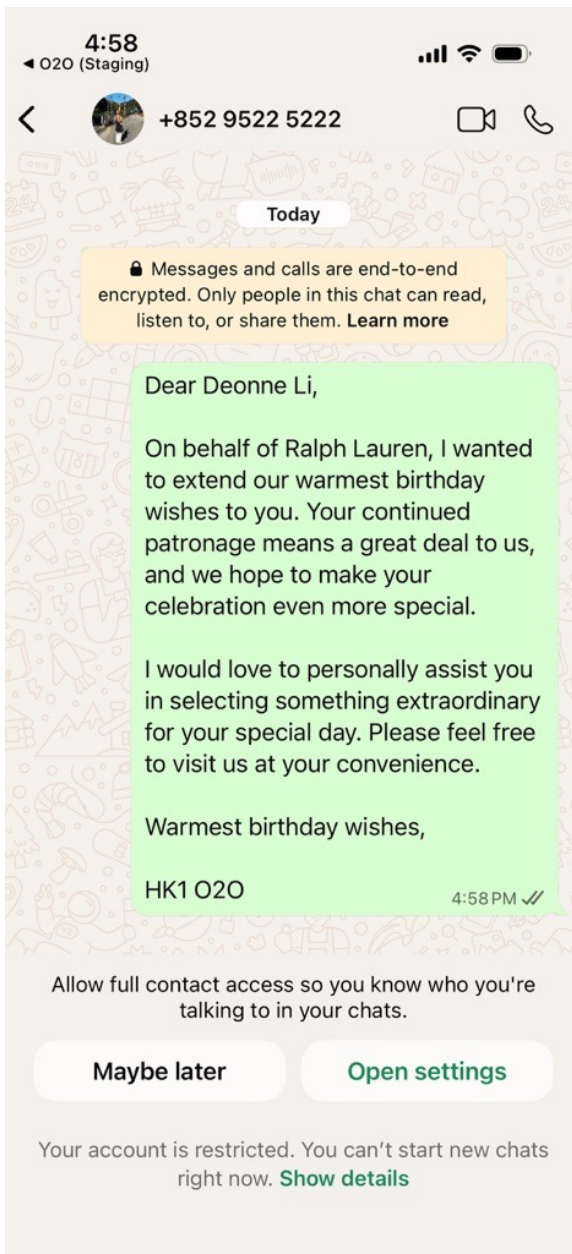
Executive Summary

Store associates in APAC, primarily Hong Kong, are intermittently receiving WhatsApp account restrictions while initiating outreach from the Ralph Lauren Clienteling application.

The latest evidence confirms: Restrictions can occur on the very first outbound message from a newly installed WhatsApp account/device The restriction appears immediately after sending a templated outreach message The behavior is occurring even when there is no apparent mass messaging activity This strongly suggests Meta/WhatsApp anti spam trust heuristics may be involved, particularly around: New device trust scoring Messaging unsaved contacts Repeated outreach patterns Corporate device reputation

Field	Details
Meeting Title	WhatsApp
Date	May 27
Participants	Shlomo ARIEL, Viswanathan, Balaji (US)

Observed Restriction Screens



Key Findings

1. Restriction Can Occur On First Message

A newly installed corporate device triggered a WhatsApp restriction immediately after the first outreach message was sent through the clienteling workflow.

2. Message Content Appears Legitimate

The outreach message was professional, luxury oriented, personalized, and non aggressive. No suspicious links or obvious spam indicators were present.

3. Unsaved Contact Hypothesis

The APAC team raised the possibility that WhatsApp may apply stricter anti spam heuristics when messages are sent to unsaved contacts from newly initialized devices.

4. Regional Concentration

The issue is primarily observed in Hong Kong and APAC. No equivalent patterns have yet been reported in Europe or

the United States.

Most Likely Root Cause

Meta/WhatsApp anti abuse systems are likely combining several trust signals: Newly installed WhatsApp accounts
New corporate managed devices Messaging unsaved contacts Repeated outreach patterns Semi templated
messaging behavior The current evidence suggests this is more likely a WhatsApp trust/reputation issue than a direct
defect in the Ralph Lauren Clienteling application itself.

Recommended Next Steps

Create a structured APAC testing matrix comparing saved vs unsaved contacts Compare new devices against
established devices Evaluate WhatsApp Business versus consumer WhatsApp accounts Capture telemetry around
restriction frequency and device/account age Investigate whether Meta regional enforcement differs in Hong
Kong/APAC Consider long term evaluation of official WhatsApp Business integrations

Conclusion

The strongest current indicator is that WhatsApp restrictions are tied to Meta trust and anti spam heuristics rather than
application level automation defects. The fact that a restriction can occur on the very first outbound message from a
newly configured device significantly strengthens the theory that device trust, unsaved contacts, and messaging
reputation scoring are major contributing factors.